



**STAN LEE
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DO NOT FALL IN NEW YORK CITY

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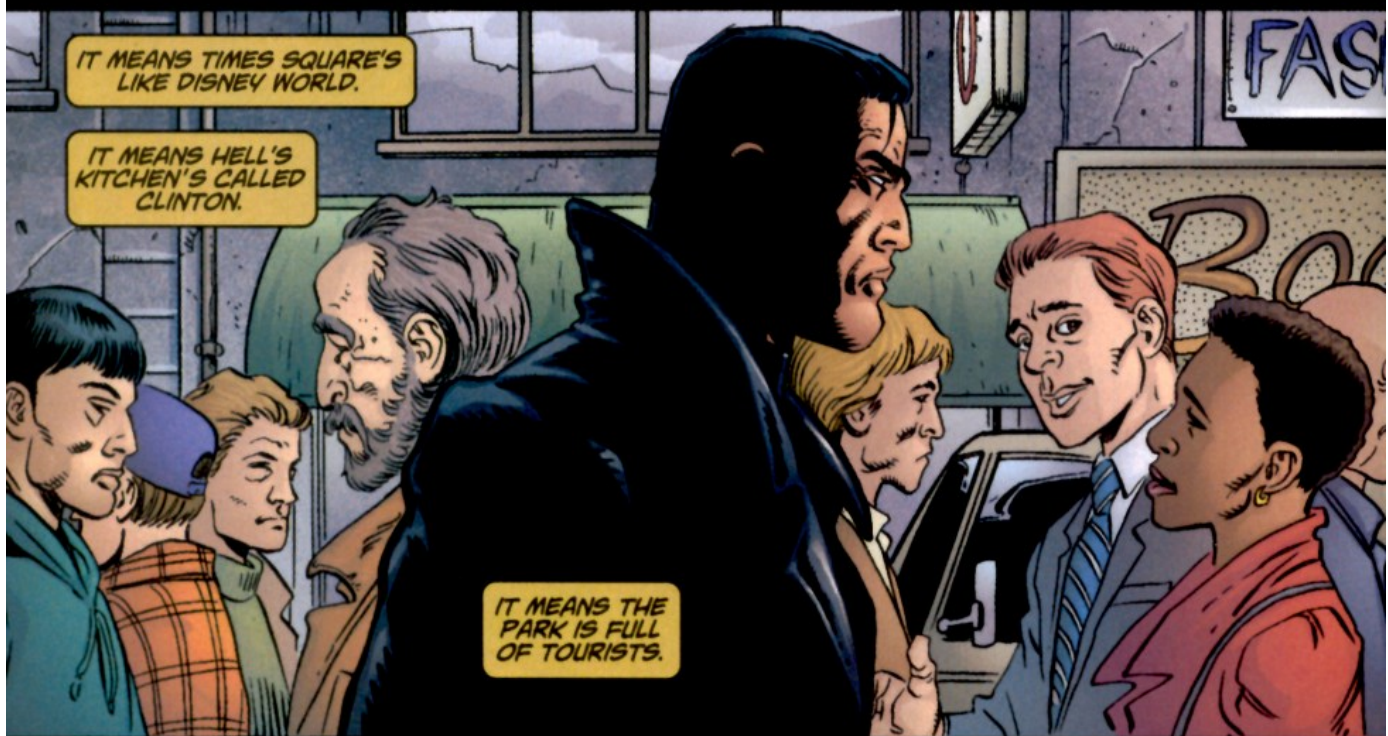


DO NOT
FALL.



FORGET THE
THINGS YOU'VE
HEARD ABOUT
THE PLACE.

ABOUT
THE NEW
NEW YORK.



IT MEANS TIMES SQUARE'S
LIKE DISNEY WORLD.

IT MEANS HELL'S
KITCHEN'S CALLED
CLINTON.

IT MEANS THE
PARK IS FULL
OF TOURISTS.



IT DOESN'T MEAN
THEY'LL CATCH YOU
WHEN YOU FALL.



THE OLD NEW YORK IS WAITING
JUST BELOW THE SURFACE.

IT'S IN THE EYES OF THE CLERK
WHO DECLINES YOUR CARD.

THE BANK MANAGER WHO
FORECLOSES ON YOUR HOUSE.



THE SURGEON WHO TELLS YOU
YOUR WIFE DIDN'T MAKE IT.



IT'S THE DISCOMFORT AND
DISGUST THAT YOUR MISERY
AWAKENS IN THEM, AS THEY
LOOK AWAY, AT ANYTHING
BUT YOU --

AS THEY
LOCK YOU
OUT OF
THE CLUB.

YOU'RE LEFT STANDING,
THINKING -- HEY, I
THOUGHT I'D MADE IT?



BUT NO ONE CARES ABOUT
YOU WHEN YOU'RE DAMNED.



JOE PERRETT'S BUSINESS
FAILED TWO YEARS BACK.

HIS SECOND
MARRIAGE ONE
WEEK LATER.

HE LOST THE FIGHT
TO KEEP THE KIDS
ON FRIDAY MORNING.

ON FRIDAY NIGHT HE
WENT TO THEIR NEW
HOME, AND SOMETIME
AFTER MIDNIGHT --
ACCORDING TO THE
KIDS' NEW FATHER --

HE SHOT
HIS EX-WIFE.

AND HIS TEN
YEAR-OLD SON.

AND HIS SIX YEAR-
OLD DAUGHTERS.

THEN HE RELOADED, THE NEW
GUY WATCHING ALL THE WHILE --
SOMEHOW NOT PASSING OUT --

AND LEFT WITHOUT
ANOTHER SHOT.

A FORTY-FIVE,
ACCORDING TO
THE POLICE.

I'M GUESSING OLD AND WORN,
U.S.M.C. ISSUE, WHITE TINPLATE
GRIPS GOT UP TO LOOK LIKE IVORY.

I KNOW
THAT GUN.

THE NIGHT THE 'SIXTY JAMMED
AND HANDED FIRST PLATOON A
NIGHTMARE.

A HILL. THREE COMPANIES
OF N.V.A.. NO AIRSTRIKE 'TIL
THE DAWN.

HOLLOW RATTLE OF M16s
FADED AS THE FIREFIGHT
DROWNED IN MUD, AND THEN
IT WAS FISTS AND BAYONETS
AND ENTRENCHING TOOLS --
STARTED GOING UNDER,
FACE WASHED IN BLOOD, ONE
HAND SLICK WITH SOMEONE'S
EYES AND THE OTHER WITH
A FISTFUL TORN FROM A
STOMACH WOUND --



AND SERGEANT PERRETT
CAME SCREAMING THROUGH
THE CHAOS LIKE A DEMON IN
THE FLARELIGHT, FORTY-FIVE
BLAZING AS HE RAN --

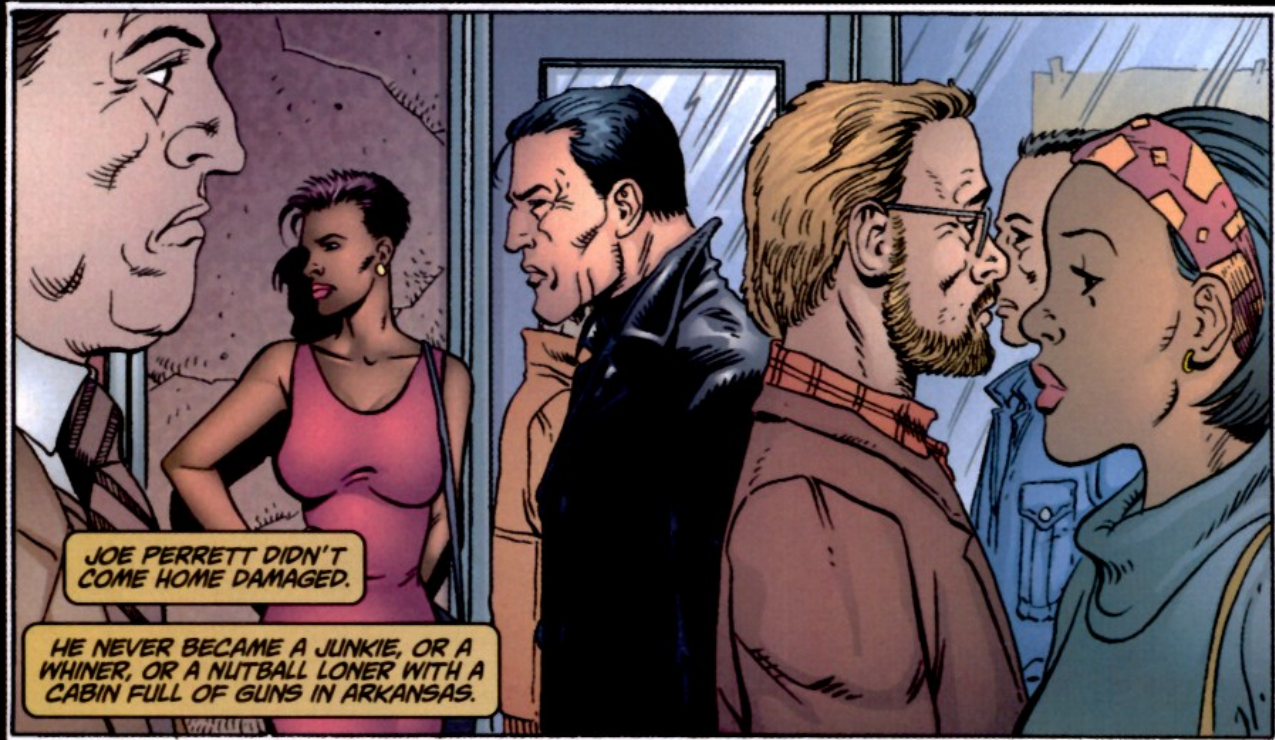


AND SAVED
LIEUTENANT
CASTLE'S LIFE.



BUT THIS IS NOT
A STORY ABOUT
VIETNAM.





JOE PERRETT DIDN'T
COME HOME DAMAGED.

HE NEVER BECAME A JUNKIE, OR A
WHINER, OR A NUTBALL LONER WITH A
CABIN FULL OF GUNS IN ARKANSAS.

OR A VIGILANTE, WHO MIGHT
HAVE GOT A TASTE FOR SOMETHING
BAD THAT NIGHT ON THE HILL.



HE FOUGHT HIS WAR AND CAME BACK
HOME, AND HE TRIED AND TRIED AND
TRIED FOR THIRTY YEARS UNTIL HE'D
NOTHING LEFT INSIDE HIM --

NOTHING TO
SHOW FOR IT --

NOTHING TO HELP HIM
SLAM THE BRAKES ON WHEN
THE DARKNESS FELL.

ONCE THE COPS HAVE HIM IT'LL BE A CIRCUS.

TIP-OFFS TO THE PAPERS.
ARREST PHOTOS FLASHED
AROUND THE WORLD.

INTERROGATION
TRANSCRIPTS ON
THE INTERNET.

BOOK DEALS FOR
EVERYONE: ARRESTING
OFFICERS, DETECTIVES,
LAWYERS, PSYCHOLOGISTS,
JUDGE AND JURY.

AND EVERY
MAGGOT WITH A
SPARE OPINION,
SPEWING INSIGHTS
NIGHTLY ON THE
SIX O'CLOCK NEWS.



A MAN LAID OPEN SO THE WORLD
CAN RUMMAGE IN HIS GUTS.



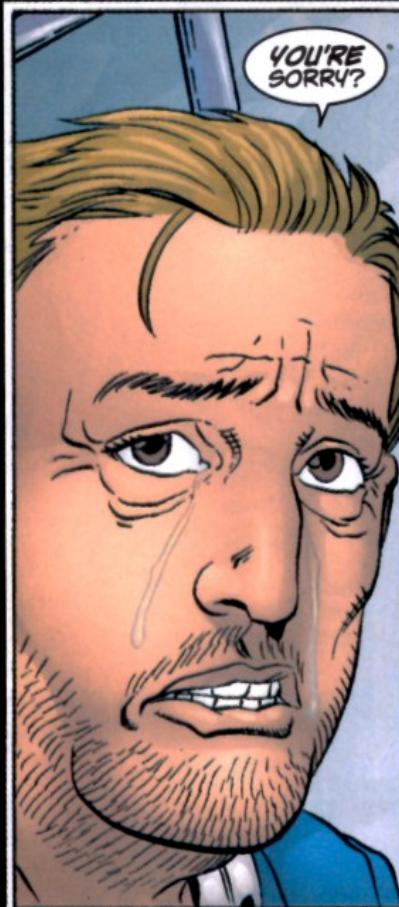
A KILLING GROUND
FOR WHORES.

BUT HERE'S
THE THING.

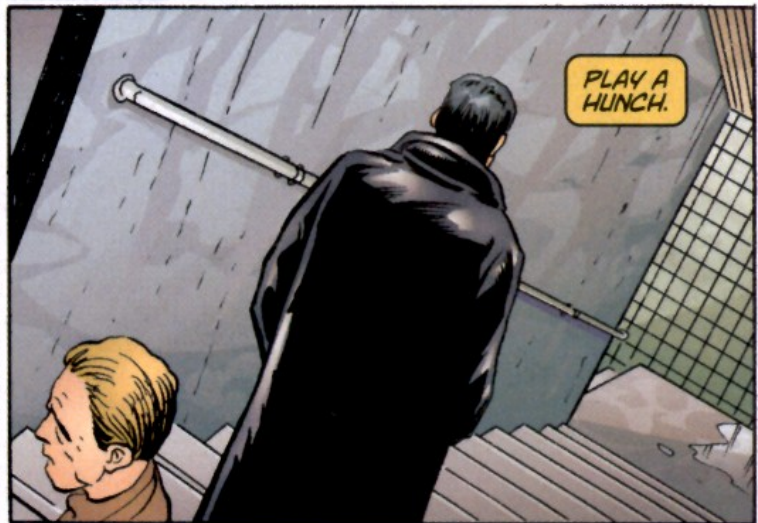
I OWE
HIM.











"YOU'RE FROM NEW YORK,
RIGHT, LIEUTENANT?"

"BROOKLYN."

"YEAH? THE KITCHEN. GREW UP ON TENTH
AVENUE. YOU KNOW I LIVED THERE MY WHOLE
LIFE AN' I NEVER DONE ANY'VE THAT STUFF
YOU'RE S'POSED TO DO?"

"WHAT STUFF?"

"YOU KNOW, ALL THE THINGS THE
TOURISTS COME TO DO. I HAD THIS
GIRLFRIEND SAID WE GOT ALL THESE
INCREDIBLE PLACES IN NEW YORK CITY,
BUT NO ONE EVER GOES TO SEE 'EM."

"UH-HUH."

"I NEVER WALKED ACROSS THE
BROOKLYN BRIDGE, OR BEEN TO
THE TOP'VE THE EMPIRE STATE
BUILDIN'. I NEVER WENT TO SEE THE
STATUE OF LIBERTY. I GOT ALL THAT
RIGHT ON MY DOORSTEP, AN' THE
FIRST TIME I GET OFF MANHATTAN
I END UP IN THIS SCUMHOLE..."

"STATUE OF
LIBERTY'S NOT ON
MANHATTAN."

"IT AIN'T?"

"IT'S ON AN ISLAND. YOU
HAVE TO GO TO BATTERY
PARK AND TAKE A FERRY."

"HOW ABOUT THAT... SO YOU
CAN SEE IT FROM NEW YORK,
BUT YOU CAN'T GET TO IT?"

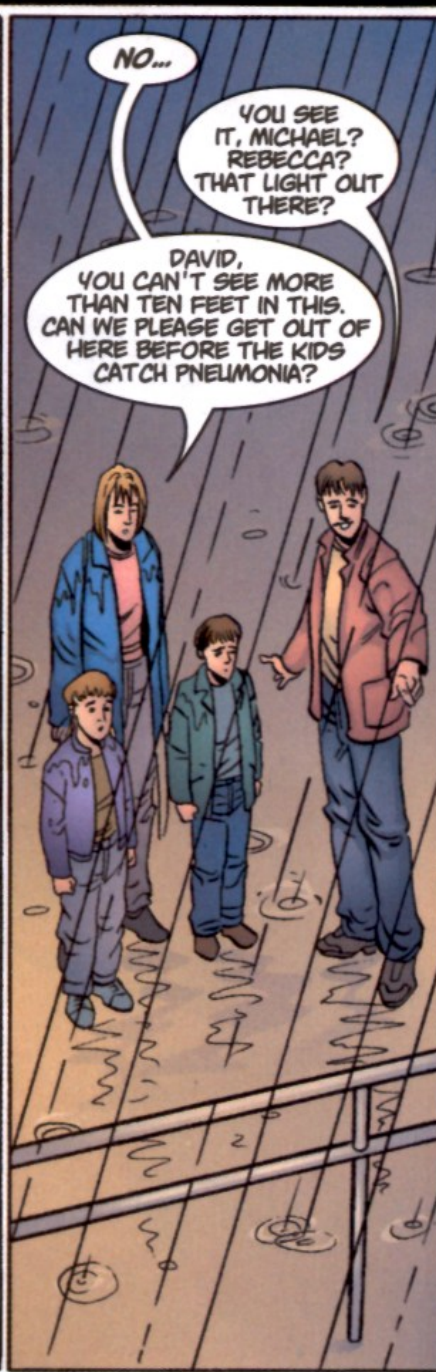
"NOT WITHOUT
TAKING THE FERRY."

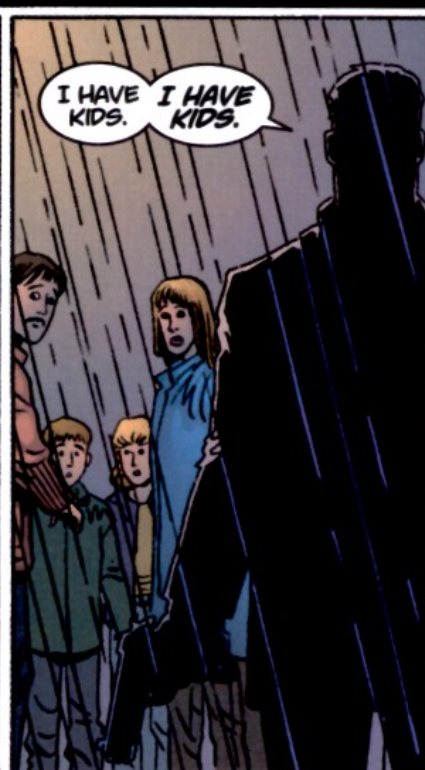
"GREAT. I
HATE BOATS."

"THERE
IT IS."

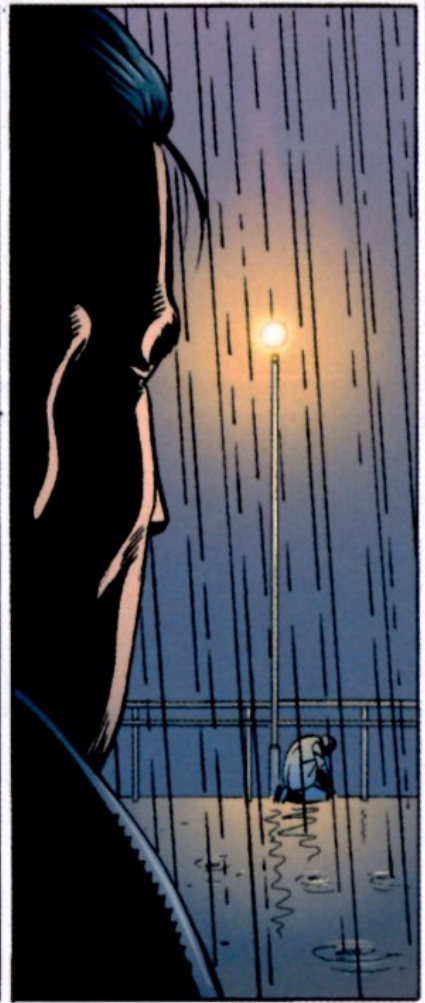
"SOMETHIN' ELSE I NEVER
KNEW. YOU WANT ME TO GET
'EM MOVIN', LIEUTENANT?"

"THANKS, SERGEANT. I'LL
TAKE A TURN ON POINT."











JUST BECAUSE
GIULIANI CHASED AWAY
THE MONSTERS --

CHASED THEM
OUT TO BROOKLYN
AND THE BRONX --

DON'T THINK
THIS PLACE HAS
CHANGED.



NOT IN
ITS HEART.

NOT WHAT
IT IS.



DO NOT FALL IN
NEW YORK CITY.

NO ONE'S GONNA
CATCH YOU WHEN
YOU DO.





I
CAUGHT
YOU.



THE END